Acceptable Use and Information Security Policy

Version 3.2 | Effective January 1 | Owner: People Operations

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how employees and contractors may use company laptops, accounts, networks and data. It protects the company, our customers and you. Questions go to it-support@company.com; suspected incidents go to security@company.com.

2. Personal Use of Company Devices

Limited personal use of a company laptop is allowed, such as browsing, personal email and streaming music, provided it does not affect your work, break the law or use significant bandwidth. Do not let family members or anyone else use your company device. Do not store personal photos, videos or files that you cannot afford to lose: company laptops may be wiped or replaced at any time without notice.

3. Software Installation

Only install software that is listed in the Self Service catalog, or approved by IT in advance. To request software that is not listed, open a ticket with the category Software Request; reviews take up to 5 working days. Pirated or cracked software, peer-to-peer file sharing tools and cryptocurrency miners are prohibited and will be removed. Browser extensions that read page content need approval before use.

4. Passwords and Multi-Factor Authentication

Passwords must be at least 12 characters with an uppercase letter, a number and a special character, and must not be reused on other services. Passwords expire every 90 days. Never share your password, MFA code or recovery codes with anyone, including IT staff: IT will never ask for your password. Use the company-approved password manager for all work credentials. MFA is mandatory on every company account and must use an authenticator app or a hardware key; SMS codes are only allowed as a temporary fallback.

5. Public Wi-Fi and Remote Work

Connect to the company VPN before accessing internal systems from any network outside the office, and always when using public Wi-Fi in cafes, airports or hotels. Do not work on confidential material where others can see your screen, and lock your screen (Windows key plus L, or Control, Command and Q on a Mac) whenever you step away. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to IT within 1 hour so that the device can be remotely locked.

6. Data Classification

6.1 The four levels

Public data may be shared freely. Internal data is for employees only. Confidential data, such as customer records, contracts and financial results, may only be shared on a need-to-know basis and must be stored in approved company systems. Restricted data, such as payment card numbers, health information, credentials and encryption keys, requires encryption and explicit approval from the security team before it is stored or transferred.

6.2 Sharing and storage

Do not email Confidential or Restricted data to personal accounts or store it on USB drives or personal cloud storage. Share files with external parties using company file sharing with an expiry date and a named recipient.

7. Reporting Security Incidents

Report a suspected security incident immediately, and within 1 hour of noticing it, to security@company.com or the security hotline. Examples include phishing emails you have clicked, lost devices, malware warnings, and accounts you suspect are compromised. Do not try to investigate or delete evidence yourself. Reports made in good faith are never penalized, even if they turn out to be false alarms.

8. Monitoring and Enforcement

The company monitors network traffic, device security status and access to company systems for security and compliance purposes. Do not expect privacy for personal use of company devices. Violations of this policy can lead to loss of access and disciplinary action, up to and including termination.